



HERALDING A GREEN REVOLUTION?

ing fire every year on an average. But as the population of EVs grows in India, even if the instances of them catching fire are rare, they have the potential of causing a lot of damage and even loss of lives. And that's where the worry about the ongoing revolution sets in.

The second revolution I have been hearing about comes from an electric mobility company that leads the pack of a relatively large number of electric scooter and motorcycle manufacturers. The plans and the manufacturing capacity for these EVs is mind-boggling, with the largest of the players already putting in place a production facility that can be scaled up to produce 10 million EVs a year. It is only because of delays due to glitches and teething troubles that, as with the first revolutionary product, we are not yet seeing the streets flooded or choked with them.

History, it seems, has a habit of repeating itself as there are reports of some of these potentially game-changing scooters catching fire. Investigations are being carried out and I believe even production has been suspended in some cases. Whatever the findings, my worry is that if these incidents continue to happen through the summer of 2022, another revolution may well grind to a halt.

As we have seen in the past, assurances from manufacturers seldom seem to assuage public concerns even though companies make visible changes to the products.

I, for one, was in the vanguard of customers for the first revolutionary product I described and as I await delivery of the second (I paid in full just last month), I realise there is a lot more at stake in this new, 'green' mobility revolution than there ever was in the first. ■



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